

**N5 Commanding Officer,
Naval Facilities Engineering Systems Command, Mid-Atlantic**

Request for Interest (RFI)

**Naval Station Great Lakes
Installation Innovation Initiative
Great Lakes, IL**

8 December 2025



Real Estate Contracting Officer

This Request for Interest includes:
Location Maps

**RESPONSES MUST BE SUBMITTED BY THURSDAY February 19, 2026/ 2:00PM
Eastern Daylight Time (EDT)**

**REQUEST FOR INTEREST
NAVAL STATION GREAT LAKES
INSTALLATION INNOVATION INITIATIVE
Naval Facilities Engineering Systems Command, Mid-Atlantic**

8 December 2025

1. AUTHORITY

This Request for Interest (RFI) invites concepts and market feedback for the potential development across multiple parcels located at Naval Station Great Lakes (NSGL) Great Lakes, Illinois. The Department of the Navy (DON) is considering the utilization of non-excess real property at NSGL, under authority of Title 10 authorities to include but not limited to: 10 U.S.C. 2667 (Leases: non-excess property of military departments and Defense Agencies) and 10 U.S.C. 2668 (Easements for rights-of-way). The DON requires In-Kind Consideration (IKC) as the form of payment, where the selected offeror delivers construction or maintenance improvements to the installation in place of cash, with typical priorities including but not limited to: roof repair, HVAC maintenance/repair, road and parking lot paving, building envelope repair, and pump station replacement/modernization. While these authorities provide a framework, the DON is open to considering other innovative responses and development concepts that may better align with its objectives.

2. SUMMARY

2.1 DESCRIPTION

The purpose of this RFI is to assess interest in a long-term partnership opportunity to develop, redevelop, or repurpose multiple parcels, including improved property at NSGL. Respondents should be interested in entering into a real estate agreement with DON in exchange for providing IKC. The DON invites Industry responders to complete and submit a response to this RFI detailing proposed redevelopment plans or other ideas/concepts for the subject property no later than 2:00 PM EST on 19 February 2026. The DON intends to use the information gathered from this RFI to evaluate potential uses of the property and determine whether to release a formal Request for Proposals (RFP). **The DON will not release or publicly use responses marked “proprietary information.”**

2.2 IN-KIND CONSIDERATION

The DON requires IKC as the form of payment for lease agreements. IKC must be provided at fair market value (FMV) and is negotiated between the DON and the selected offeror as an annual dollar amount. That obligation is satisfied through construction, maintenance, services, or other improvements performed at the installation. The IKC payment functions as rent and recurs for the duration of the lease term. The DON identifies the priorities, and the selected offeror delivers work equal to the negotiated value.

2.3 OPPORTUNITY

Responses to this RFI will inform the DON's determination on whether to issue a formal Request for Proposals (RFP). If an RFP is released, selected offerors may be granted long-term leasehold interests in federal property under 10 U.S.C. § 2667. Assessing federal property under this authority offers advantages rarely available to the open market. These agreements allow private industry to access well-located federal land under terms backed by the U.S. Government. The property remains under federal ownership, which generally results in exemption from state and local property taxes. Additional benefits may include exemption from local zoning restrictions, and long-term lease terms up to 50 years. The conditions offer stability and predictability, which are not commonly available in commercial real estate transactions.

2.4 REQUEST FOR INTEREST

The purpose of this RFI is to serve as a market research tool to better understand current market conditions by gathering information in a formal, structured, and fair manner. The DON desires to engage industry to obtain information and levels of interest to help the Government prepare a course of action for potential long-term development, redevelopment, or reuse of multiple parcels at NSGL. This RFI process will help assist the Government in developing an informed solicitation document with clear competitive requirements. This RFI does not obligate the Government to enter into an agreement or purchase services from any respondent. The DON reserves the right to cancel this RFI at any time. All costs incurred in responding to this RFI will be solely and exclusively at the responder's expense.

3. BACKGROUND

3.1 HISTORY

NSGL, located in Great Lakes, Illinois, is home to the U.S. Navy's largest training installation and serves as the cornerstone of naval readiness. It is home to the Recruit Training Command (RTC), the Navy's sole bootcamp for enlisted personnel, where over 40,000 recruits undergo training annually. Since its establishment in 1911, NSGL has trained more than two million Sailors, shaping the future of the fleet and ensuring operational readiness. Beyond basic training, NSGL houses several technical schools and training centers, providing advanced technical instruction to enlisted personnel, equipping them with the specialized skills necessary for modern naval operations. As a key component of the Navy's training infrastructure, NSGL plays a critical role in preparing the next generation of Sailors to meet the evolving demands of naval warfare.

3.2. REGIONAL ECONOMIC IMPACT

NSGL brings steady activity in Lake County. Each year, more than 40,000 civilians become Sailors here and 11,000 of them go on to complete technical training here. The installation hosts 48 recruit graduations annually, drawing over 200,000 visitors whose lodging, dining, and retail activity accounts for more than 60 percent of the county's \$1.2 billion tourism economy. Weekly graduation traffic results in 900 - 1,100 out-of-state vehicles along Buckley Road, underscoring the ongoing demand that supports local hospitality, restaurant, and retail sectors.

The Navy continues to invest heavily in NSGL, with major construction projects underway, 1,365 family housing units, and a newly built elementary school serving military families. In addition, on-base operations sustain civilian jobs and create ongoing demand for everyday goods and services, offering consistent activity that benefits the surrounding community.

3.3 PROJECT OBJECTIVES

The primary goal of this RFI is to gather valuable insights, concepts, and expertise from industry leaders and stakeholders to explore market interest and potential uses for underutilized property at NSGL, including opportunities for the long-term development, redevelopment, or reuse of parcels at NSGL. The focus is on identifying land uses and partnership structures that align with the Department of Defense's (DoD) priorities for mission readiness, compatible land use, and economic value generation while supporting mutually beneficial outcomes for both the installation and surrounding community. NSGL seeks long-term partnerships with private entities to create commercially viable solutions that represent the highest and best use of the subject properties within applicable Navy, federal, state, and local requirements.

Key objectives for this initiative include, but are not limited to:

- **Maximize Value:** Identify highest and best use development or redevelopment opportunities that generate revenue to support facility repairs and long-term needs, provided through IKC negotiated with the Navy.
- **Preferred Uses:** The Navy has identified preferred uses that may be suitable for these parcels, including data centers, energy utilities, light industrial, and hospitality and commercial/mixed-use.

4 POTENTIAL SITE LOCATION(S)

The installation spans more than 1,600 acres and serves as the Navy's largest training facility. Four sites have been identified as potential opportunities for development or redevelopment under this RFI. The parcels vary in size, location, and existing conditions. The **Location Map is provided in Attachment A.**

Site Location 1 is located at 2016 Ray Street, Great Lakes, Illinois, 60088. This location includes three distinct parcels totaling approximately 11.5 acres:

- **Parcel 1 (South) – 2.2 acres:** Vacant and undeveloped land. Occasionally used for controlled burn training. Available for development.
- **Parcel 2 (Central) – 6.2 acres:** Includes three buildings (Building 2016, 2017, and 8301). Building 2016 is not actively utilized and may be repurposed or demolished. Buildings 2017 and 8301 are used for storage with limited utility service. Relocation of all existing functions is required prior to development. The storage uses in Buildings 2017 and 8301 are not dependent on specialized systems or equipment and can be relocated as needed.

- **Existing Structure(s):**
 - Building 2016: 27,264 square feet (Office Space)
 - Building 2017: 1,620 square feet (Storage Space)
 - Building 8301: 2,805 square feet (Storage Space)
- **Parcel 3 (North)** – 3.1 acres: Currently functions as Morale, Welfare, and Recreation (MWR) RV parking lot. Would require relocation.

Site Location 2 is located at 2101 Saipan Drive, Building 8801, Glenview, Illinois, 60026.

- **Parcel Description:** The site comprises a single 2.5-acre parcel located adjacent to the Glen Town Center. The property was previously used by the Navy’s Child and Youth Program (CYP) and has since been vacated.
- **Existing Structure:** One commercial facility (Building 8801), approximately 13,876 square feet, constructed in 1999. The building previously operated as a Child Development Center.

Site Location 3 is located near Buildings 132H and 130H, along Sheridan Road in North Chicago, Illinois

- **Parcel Description:** The 4.66-acre parcel is located in the southern portion of NSGL with frontage along Sheridan Road. Approximately half the site (2.33 acres) contains a former dormitory building while the remaining 2.33 acres consist of undeveloped land.
- **Existing Structure:** A 96,116 square foot dormitory building, vacant since 2010. Demolition is scheduled for 2026. Redevelopment may be considered.

Site Location 4 is located directly east of Sheridan Road and north Farragut Avenue in Great Lakes, Illinois

- **Parcel Description:** The site comprises approximately 2 acres of raw land located adjacent to the National Museum of the American Sailor and situated just north of the museum’s parking lot. The parcel fronts Sheridan Road which serves as a key regional arterial and public access corridor.
- **Existing Structure:** None

5 RFI RESPONSE CONTENT

Respondents should include the following in their response:

- **Company Overview:** Provide an introduction to your company, including its history, areas of expertise, and relevant experience with real estate development, public-private partnerships, or projects of similar scale and complexity. Highlight any past projects involving government, institutional, or infrastructure-related real estate.
- **Development Experience:** Describe your firm’s experience with projects of a similar type, scale, or complexity. Include examples of projects involving data centers, energy utilities, light industrial, hospitality, or commercial/mixed-use facilities, or other developments that demonstrate your qualifications.
- **Development Approach:** If your organization sees an opportunity to utilize or redevelop the Premises, provide a statement describing the overall development concept and

- approach. Explain how the proposed use aligns with market opportunities, industry demand, and compatibility with the DON's objectives.
- iv. **In-Kind Consideration:** The Navy anticipates use of its outgrant authority under 10 U.S.C. § 2667, which allows acceptance of IKC in lieu of cash rent. Cash rent will not be accepted. Respondents should indicate the types of IKC they would be willing to provide as part of a potential transaction. Respondents should include a plan to provide IKC to the DON of not less than Fair Market Value (FMV). NSGL's preferred forms of IKC include roof repair, HVAC maintenance and repair, road and parking lot paving, building envelope repair, and pump station replacement or modernization. While these items reflect current installation priorities, the DON remains open to alternative services or improvements that may provide greater cost efficiency or mission-enhancing value. What types of IKC would you be willing to explore? Please include references to the relevant statutory authorities that describe the types of IKC the government may accept.
 - v. **Proposed Use:** Describe the nature and purpose of the proposed use, including the type of development envisioned and its intended operations. Identify the scope of facilities to be constructed or redeveloped and explain how the proposed use would meet market demand while remaining compatible with surrounding property.
 - vi. **Financing and Management:** Outline your strategy for financing, developing, and managing the property.
 - vii. **Parcel Requirements:** Identify the area of the property required for your proposed concept. State whether the entire Premises would be used or specify which portions would be required and explain why. If suggesting partial development, define which portions would be used and how they integrate with surrounding areas. Respondents may use the Location Map (Attachment A) to redefine boundaries, if necessary.
 - viii. **Timeline and Proposal Preparation:** If a formal solicitation follows this RFI, state the timeframe your organization would require to prepare and submit a proposal.
 - ix. **Infrastructure and Utility Considerations:** Do you anticipate the need for major infrastructure improvements, such as road alignments or utility upgrades? Identify what municipal utilities or infrastructure support would be required for your proposed development.
 - x. **Regulatory Constraints:** Describe any additional factors or regulatory considerations that may impact your ability to develop the property.
 - xi. **Community Compatibility:** Describe how your proposed development concept aligns with surrounding land uses and supports regional economic development goals.
 - xii. **Additional Information:** Include any additional information or innovative suggestions that would be useful to the DON in evaluating market interest. This may include further detail on potential IKC opportunities beyond those identified by NSGL, or alternative development concepts that offer benefits to the installation and the surrounding community.

All information submitted in response to this RFI will be considered business confidential. Submitting a response to this RFI is not mandatory for participating in any future formal RFP process. However, information gathered through this RFI may significantly influence the DON's approach and strategy in subsequent procurement processes. This RFI aims to solicit maximum industry participation to develop a robust energy resilience strategy that aligns with both the DON's and developers' goals, ensuring a successful and impactful project.

6 INDUSTRY DAY

The DON will host an in-person Industry Day in connection with this RFI. The event will provide a high-level overview of how real estate opportunities are structured with the federal government, outline Naval Station Great Lakes' objectives, describe the available parcels, and conclude with a Q&A session. Interested parties must submit RSVPs using the Microsoft Forms link no later than 15 January 2025. Do not email RSVPs.

RSVP link: <https://forms.office.com/r/qcsDkQVW3a>

The Industry Day will include:

- An introductory session to review the opportunity and goals of the RFI
- No site tour will be conducted, as all sites are accessible to the public.
- A formal Q&A session will be held. All questions and responses will be documented and made publicly available on SAM.gov following the event.

Direct Industry Day specific questions to michael.p.quinlan15.civ@us.navy.mil. Use the subject line "Industry Day Questions - NSGL RFI".

7 QUESTIONS

Please direct any questions regarding this RFI to the government project team listed below. All questions must be submitted by February 05, 2025. The DON will respond to questions via a public posting on SAM.gov.

RFI Questions should be sent via email to:

- derek.a.crute2.civ@us.navy.mil

Please use the subject line "NSGL RFI Questions".

8 RFI RESPONSE SUBMISSION

RFI RESPONSE DUE DATE. Written submittals are due no later than 2:00 PM EDT on Thursday 19 February 2026. All costs associated with any RFI response shall be at the responder's sole expense and shall not be reimbursed by the DON. Please be advised that all submissions become Government property and will not be returned. RFI responses should be sent via email to:

- derek.a.crute2.civ@us.navy.mil

Please use the subject line "Response to NSGL RFI".
Limit responses to 10 pages and limit file sizes to 5MB.

PROPRIETARY INFORMATION. Proprietary information included in the RFI submittal **MUST BE CLEARLY MARKED.**

9 RFI RESPONSE

RFI response shall address the content set out in RFI RESPONSE CONTENT, to include:

- Company Overview
- Development Experience
- Development Approach
- In-Kind Consideration
- Proposed Use
- Financing and Management
- Parcel Requirements
- Timeline & Proposal Preparation
- Infrastructure and Utility Considerations
- Regulatory Constraints
- Community Compatibility
- Additional Information

10 RFI ATTACHMENTS

A. Location Maps